Execution Skills Tutorial Packet

Tutorials 1-15: Orders, risk, alerts, VWAP/SMA context, microstructure, options basics, cash-secured puts, and price-path simulation

Built from the May 3, 2026 student coaching session and expanded with source-backed study notes for classroom use.

Student safety rule

This packet is for education and paper-trading practice. It is not financial advice, does not recommend any security, and should not be used as a live-money signal. All ticker examples are case studies.

Training philosophy

The student should master order placement, stop logic, and support/resistance before adding options, cash-secured puts, or quantitative simulation. The goal is to trade less emotionally by using written rules.

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How to Use This Packet

This packet turns the May 3 coaching session into a structured execution curriculum. It is designed for a student who is learning to move from chart observation into practical trade planning without jumping too quickly into live risk.

Each tutorial includes a session anchor, objective, core rule, step-by-step protocol, common mistakes, student drill, and mastery checkpoint. The instructor can assign one tutorial per study session or combine related tutorials into weekly blocks.

Recommended 4-week teaching sequence

Week	Modules	Focus
Week 1	Tutorials 1-5	Order tickets, SPY context, stop logic, scaling out, alerts
Week 2	Tutorials 6-10	VWAP/SMA setup, microstructure, support/resistance, breakout targets, style switching
Week 3	Tutorials 11-13	Low-priced-stock risk, long calls/puts, cash-secured puts
Week 4	Tutorials 14-15	Price-path simulation, paper-trade journal, review loop

Instructor note

The curriculum is intentionally sequenced. Do not let the student skip from support/resistance directly to cash-secured puts or short options. The mechanical execution layer must come first.

Skill Progression Map

Layer	Skills	Student milestone
Foundation	Order types, stops, risk/reward, alerts	Can place correct paper orders and define invalidation before entry
Chart structure	VWAP/SMA, microstructures, support/resistance, breakout targets	Can map levels and explain why a level matters
Execution mode	Scalping vs. momentum, scale-outs, stop movement	Can switch styles only after confirmation
Instrument selection	Shares vs. options, long calls/puts, cash-secured puts	Can choose the correct instrument for the thesis
Decision science	Price-path simulation, journal review, paper-to-small-size protocol	Can plan for multiple outcomes and review process quality

Minimum live-readiness standard

- 30 complete paper-trade journal entries.
- No repeated order-ticket mistakes.
- Every trade has entry, stop, target, and risk/reward before execution.
- Student can explain when not to trade.
- Student understands that options can lose all premium and low-priced stocks can be highly risky.

Tutorial 1: Order Placement Basics: Limit Orders, Stops, and Avoiding Execution Mistakes

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	Anthony discussed broker permissions, an execution problem in a low-priced name, and the need to understand entries before trading live. The pasted coaching notes also emphasized buy limits below current price and sell limits above current price.
Objective	Make the student mechanically fluent with basic order tickets before real money is used.
Core rule	A trade idea is incomplete until the student can place the correct order type at the correct price.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Start with the current bid, ask, and last price. The last price is not the same thing as guaranteed execution.
2. For a planned long entry, use a buy limit at the price you are willing to pay or lower. Do not chase with a market order unless the plan specifically allows it.
3. For a planned exit or short-side sale, use a sell limit at the price you are willing to accept or higher.
4. Use a stop-loss order only after defining the invalidation level. A stop should answer: "Where is my thesis wrong?"
5. For fast-moving names, discuss stop-limit vs. stop-market tradeoffs before placing the order. Stop-market improves probability of exit, while stop-limit improves price control but may not fill.
6. Before hitting submit, read the ticket aloud: symbol, side, quantity, order type, limit/stop price, time-in-force, and account type.
7. Use paper trading until the student can place orders without reversing buy/sell logic or confusing limit and stop prices.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Buying with a limit order above the market by accident when the intent was to wait for a pullback.
- Selling with a limit order below the market by accident when the intent was to take profit higher.
- Assuming a stop guarantees a perfect exit price in a fast market.
- Using market orders in low-liquidity or wide-spread names without checking the spread.

Student drill

Place 20 paper orders: 5 buy limits, 5 sell limits, 5 stop-loss orders, 5 stop-limit orders. For every ticket, write what triggers it, what price can fill, and what could go wrong.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can look at any chart and correctly state: "My planned entry is ___, my order type is ___, my stop is ___, and my first exit is ___."

Source-backed study note: Investor.gov defines limit orders as orders at a specified price or better, and stop orders as orders that become market orders once the stop price is reached. See Sources [1] and [2].

Tutorial 2: SPY / S&P 500 Case Study: Trading Near Market Extremes

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	The lesson used SPY/S&P 500 as a broad market barometer and discussed how buying a put near a major high requires very tight risk control.
Objective	Teach location awareness: market extremes demand different behavior than mid-range trading.
Core rule	Before selecting calls or puts, identify where price sits relative to major highs, lows, and current structure.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Open SPY first to understand the broad market environment before analyzing single names.
2. Mark the prior major high, prior major low, current support, and current resistance.
3. Ask whether the trade is being initiated at the top of a move, the bottom of a move, or the middle of a range.
4. If buying puts near a major high, use a tighter stop because a breakout can invalidate the idea quickly.
5. If buying calls near a major low, define the bounce level and the level that would prove the bounce failed.
6. Compare the single stock to SPY. If SPY is rising and the stock is falling, the stock may have company-specific weakness or relative underperformance.
7. Avoid confusing a broad-market idea with a single-stock idea. They can disagree.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Treating SPY as a guaranteed predictor for every stock.
- Buying puts at all-time highs without a stop because the trader "feels" it should reverse.
- Buying calls just because the market dipped, without confirming support or a reaction level.
- Ignoring relative strength and relative weakness versus the index.

Student drill

On a SPY chart, mark the major high, major low, midpoint, current support, and current resistance. Then write three plans: call plan, put plan, and no-trade plan.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can explain whether a setup is near the top, bottom, or middle of the current market structure and how that changes stop placement.

Source-backed study note: StockCharts frames support and resistance as zones where supply and demand meet. See Source [6].

Tutorial 3: Tight Stop Losses and Risk-to-Reward Ratios

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	Anthony explained that a tight stop protects money when the trader does not know what will happen next. The session then connected that idea to risk/reward ratios.
Objective	Teach students to define maximum loss and reward expectation before entry.
Core rule	Risk comes first. Reward comes second. Entry comes last.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Write the thesis in one sentence: "I expect price to move because ___."
2. Mark invalidation: the chart level that proves the thesis wrong.
3. Calculate dollar risk per share or per option contract before entering.
4. Set the first target at a logical chart level, not at an emotional profit number.
5. Calculate reward-to-risk: potential reward divided by planned risk.
6. Reject any trade where the student cannot locate both invalidation and target.
7. After entry, do not widen the stop to avoid being wrong. Moving stops farther away should require a new written thesis.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Entering first and deciding risk later.
- Widening stops after price moves against the trade.
- Using a one-to-one trade when the chart has no room to pay the risk.
- Confusing position size with risk. A small position can still be poorly structured.

Student drill

Create three hypothetical trades with 1:1, 1:2, and 1:3 reward-to-risk. For each, calculate entry, stop, target, dollar risk, and dollar reward.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can reject a tempting setup because the risk/reward is poor.

Source-backed study note: FINRA warns that day trading can be extremely risky and may be inappropriate for traders with limited resources or low risk tolerance. See Source [16].

Tutorial 4: Scaling Out: Partial Profits at Necklines, Microstructures, and Bounce Zones

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	The session explored dummy trades and discussed exiting before a major dip destroys an option contract. Scaling out was framed as a way to avoid greed and protect gains.
Objective	Teach students how to exit in pieces instead of trying to catch the entire move.
Core rule	Partial profits convert uncertainty into structure.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Before entry, identify first target, second target, and final runner level.
2. If trading multiple contracts or share lots, assign each portion a purpose: pay yourself, reduce risk, and leave a runner.
3. Take the first scale-out at the nearest logical level: neckline, VWAP, prior support/resistance, or microstructure.
4. After the first scale-out, move the stop on the remaining position only if the chart supports it.
5. Do not scale out randomly. Each exit should be tied to a level or a rule.
6. If the first target is too close to justify the risk, skip the trade.
7. Journal whether the scale-out reduced stress and improved execution.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Holding the full position because the trader wants a home run.
- Scaling out too early with no plan, then chasing back in emotionally.
- Selling only winners and leaving losers unmanaged.
- Assuming partial profits fix a bad entry.

Student drill

Paper trade five positions using three exits: first scale-out, second scale-out, and final runner. Write the reason for each exit before placing the entry.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can say what portion exits at each level and why.

Source-backed study note: TradingView Paper Trading can be used to practice chart-based entries and exits without real-money execution. See Source [5].

Tutorial 5: Alerts as Risk Management: Exit, Observe, and Re-Enter With a Fresh Bias

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	The session showed Anthony setting alerts around bounce and structure levels, then reframed alerts as risk management rather than convenience.
Objective	Turn alerts into part of the trade plan: entry, invalidation, profit-taking, and re-entry.
Core rule	No key level should exist only in the trader's memory.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Draw the level first: support, resistance, neckline, VWAP, moving average, or microstructure.
2. Create an alert at the entry trigger level only after the trigger has been defined.
3. Create a separate alert at invalidation. This is the "stop thinking and act" level.
4. Create a target alert where partial profits should be considered.
5. Create a re-entry alert for a fresh setup after the first trade is closed.
6. Label each alert with the planned action: observe, enter, exit, scale, or re-evaluate.
7. When the alert fires, re-check the chart before acting. An alert is a prompt, not a signal by itself.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Setting only one price alert and expecting it to manage the entire trade.
- Leaving old alerts active after the trade thesis changes.
- Using alerts to chase price rather than to execute a prewritten plan.
- Failing to distinguish "observe" alerts from "act" alerts.

Student drill

For one chart, set four paper alerts: entry trigger, invalidation, first target, and re-entry trigger. Each alert label must include the planned response.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can exit, wait, and re-enter only when a new setup forms instead of reacting emotionally.

Source-backed study note: TradingView support documents multiple ways to create alerts, including from the toolbar, alert manager, right-click menu, drawing panel, price scale, and keyboard shortcuts. See Source [4].

Tutorial 6: VWAP, SMA 9/50/200, and Price Magnets

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	The student notes emphasized VWAP plus SMA 9, SMA 50, and SMA 200. The transcript also shows discussion of SMA/EMA and later ATR/VWAP as next-stage indicator tools.
Objective	Teach indicators as context tools for price magnets, trend, support, and resistance.
Core rule	Indicators do not replace structure. They help organize structure.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Add VWAP to the intraday chart and explain that it measures average price weighted by volume.
2. Add SMA 9 for short-term momentum context, SMA 50 for intermediate trend context, and SMA 200 for major trend context.
3. Use different colors and line thicknesses so the student can identify each line instantly.
4. When price is far from VWAP, ask whether the trade is extended and vulnerable to mean reversion.
5. When price is near SMA 50 or SMA 200, treat the area as a potential institutional attention zone, not an automatic trade.
6. During a scalp, practice moving the stop toward VWAP only after price has moved in favor of the trade and the structure allows it.
7. Use anchored VWAP manually from major highs and lows to reduce noise and focus on meaningful pivots.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Using VWAP or SMA contact as an automatic buy or sell signal.
- Adding too many indicators until the chart becomes unreadable.
- Failing to distinguish intraday VWAP from longer-term moving averages.
- Moving a stop to VWAP too early and choking off a valid trade.

Student drill

Build a clean chart template with VWAP, SMA 9, SMA 50, and SMA 200. Take a screenshot and label which line is short-term, intraday, intermediate, and major trend context.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can explain what each line is doing before discussing an entry.

Source-backed study note: TradingView describes VWAP as a tool that measures average price weighted by volume and is commonly used on intraday charts. StockCharts discusses 50-day and 200-day SMAs as trend and support/resistance references. See Sources [3] and [7].

Tutorial 7: Microstructures: Reading Small Patterns Inside Bigger Structures

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	Anthony identified pullbacks, small triangles, floor areas, and short-term structures. The lesson connected these small structures to larger support/resistance planning.
Objective	Teach 3-minute, 5-minute, and 15-minute structure without losing the larger context.
Core rule	Microstructure is useful only when it fits the bigger map.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Start on the higher timeframe to identify the dominant structure.
2. Move to the 15-minute chart to locate the current intraday battleground.
3. Move to the 5-minute or 3-minute chart to plan entries and exits.
4. Mark pullbacks, compression, miniature triangles, and repeated bounce zones.
5. Label each microstructure as support, resistance, continuation, or failure risk.
6. Ask whether the microstructure is aligned with the larger trend or fighting it.
7. Use the microstructure for timing, not for replacing risk management.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Trading every tiny pattern as if it is equally important.
- Ignoring the daily or hourly chart while staring at the 3-minute chart.
- Calling a one-touch level "major support" before it proves itself.
- Confusing noisy chop with tradable compression.

Student drill

On a 5-minute chart, mark three microstructures. For each, write entry idea, invalidation, first target, and larger-timeframe alignment.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can describe whether a microstructure supports a scalp, momentum trade, or no-trade decision.

Source-backed study note: StockCharts defines support and resistance around supply and demand, which helps formalize microstructure levels. See Source [6].

Tutorial 8: Support and Resistance: Roof, Foundation, Minor, Current, and Major Levels

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	The session used the house analogy: resistance is the roof and support is the foundation. It also distinguished current, minor, and major levels by touch count and context.
Objective	Turn line drawing into a classification system.
Core rule	A level becomes stronger as evidence accumulates.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Define resistance as the roof: a level above price where selling or hesitation may appear.
2. Define support as the foundation: a level below price where buying or stabilization may appear.
3. Classify one-touch levels as current or minor until they prove themselves.
4. Upgrade a level toward major only after repeated reactions, historical importance, or high-volume participation.
5. Track whether prior support turns into resistance or prior resistance turns into support.
6. Draw zones instead of thin perfect lines when price reactions are messy.
7. Update labels when new evidence appears. A level can gain or lose importance.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Calling a level major because it looks important once.
- Drawing too many lines until every price becomes a level.
- Ignoring failed support/resistance flips.
- Moving lines to fit the trade after entry.

Student drill

Give the student one chart and require each line to be labeled: current support, minor support, major support, current resistance, minor resistance, or major resistance.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can explain why a level is weak, moderate, or strong using touches and historical context.

Source-backed study note: StockCharts describes support and resistance as key junctures where supply and demand meet. See Source [6].

Tutorial 9: Breakout Targets: Where Does the Breakout Stop?

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	The session asked what to do after spotting a breakout and then refined the answer into mapping minor and major resistance targets.
Objective	Teach that a breakout entry is incomplete without a target map.
Core rule	Do not trade the breakout until you know where the breakout might stall.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Mark the breakout level and the candle that confirms it.
2. Identify first target: nearest minor resistance or prior reaction zone.
3. Identify second target: major resistance, SMA 50/200, VWAP band, or prior high.
4. Define invalidation: the level that proves the breakout failed.
5. Wait for a clean close on the relevant timeframe when the trade style requires confirmation.
6. Watch volume and candle quality. A breakout with weak participation is more likely to fake out.
7. After target one, decide whether the trade becomes a runner or a completed scalp.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Buying a breakout with no exit target.
- Entering on the first wick above resistance without waiting for confirmation.
- Assuming all breakouts become momentum trades.
- Ignoring the next resistance level directly overhead.

Student drill

For three breakout charts, identify breakout level, first resistance, second resistance, invalidation, and volume condition.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can state: "If it breaks, target one is ___, target two is ___, and the breakout fails if ___."

Source-backed study note: StockCharts moving-average material explains how widely watched averages can act as support or resistance. See Source [7].

Tutorial 10: Scalping vs. Momentum Trading: When to Shift Styles

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	The coaching notes emphasized 5-minute and 15-minute observation, staggered scalp entries/exits, and waiting for cleaner higher-timeframe breakout confirmation before shifting into momentum mode.
Objective	Teach students to separate fast defensive scalps from cleaner continuation trades.
Core rule	Scalping is a fast execution mode. Momentum trading is a confirmation mode.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Begin with the 15-minute chart to decide whether the market is ranging, compressing, or breaking out.
2. Use the 5-minute chart to evaluate whether price action is clean enough for a scalp or too choppy to trade.
3. For scalps, stagger orders around planned levels rather than entering all at once with no structure.
4. For scalps, manage stops actively and consider moving the stop toward VWAP after the trade moves in favor.
5. For momentum trades, wait for a clean breakout above structural resistance or below structural support.
6. Do not switch from scalp to momentum just because the trader wants more profit. Switch only when the chart confirms expansion.
7. After a false breakout, return to observation mode and wait for the next structure.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Turning a scalp into a swing because the trade went red.
- Switching styles mid-trade without a chart-based reason.
- Entering momentum mode on a wick or noisy breakout.
- Using a scalp-sized stop for a momentum trade or a momentum-sized stop for a scalp.

Student drill

Take one symbol and classify each 15-minute block as scalp-only, momentum candidate, or no-trade. Then compare the labels to actual price behavior.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can explain why a setup is scalp-only, momentum-ready, or untradeable.

Source-backed study note: VWAP and moving averages can help frame intraday trend and potential dynamic support/resistance, but they should not be used as automatic signals. See Sources [3] and [7].

Tutorial 11: Low-Priced Stocks, Meme Stocks, and the Shares vs. Options Decision

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	AMC and other low-priced names became a teaching moment: sometimes shares may be cleaner than short-dated calls because options can lose most of their value quickly.
Objective	Teach instrument selection: stock, option, or no trade.
Core rule	A low share price does not automatically mean a low-risk trade.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Check whether the name is low-priced, thinly traded, or wide-spread before considering options.
2. Compare buying 100 shares with buying one call contract. Write maximum loss, breakeven logic, and what must happen for profit.
3. For low-priced stocks, inspect volume and spread before choosing shares or options.
4. Remember that options have expiration and can lose value even if the stock does not collapse.
5. When the stock is near $1 or under $5, discuss listing risk, liquidity, and broker restrictions before trading.
6. Use shares when the thesis is ownership or accumulation. Use options only when the student understands time decay and liquidity.
7. Avoid low-priced names with no clear catalyst, no liquidity, and no risk plan.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Thinking a $1 stock is automatically cheap or safe.
- Buying options on low-liquidity names without checking the bid/ask spread.
- Ignoring expiration when the thesis is "maybe it recovers later."
- Using options because they feel cheaper than shares while actually carrying greater probability of total loss.

Student drill

Compare three instruments on one low-priced stock: 100 shares, one call option, and no trade. For each, write capital required, maximum loss, liquidity risk, and thesis requirement.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can explain when buying shares is cleaner than buying a short-dated option.

Source-backed study note: The SEC warns that microcap stocks are among the riskiest investments, and Nasdaq rules include a $1 minimum bid-price requirement for certain listings. See Sources [8] and [14].

Tutorial 12: Long Calls and Long Puts Before Short Options

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	The session explicitly kept Anthony focused on long calls and long puts before short calls, short puts, or spreads.
Objective	Build a safer beginner options path: directional options first, advanced obligations later.
Core rule	Learn rights before obligations.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Define a call: a contract giving the holder the right to buy the underlying at the strike before expiration.
2. Define a put: a contract giving the holder the right to sell the underlying at the strike before expiration.
3. For beginners, paper trade long calls for bullish directional ideas and long puts for bearish directional ideas.
4. Write the maximum loss before entry: the premium paid plus costs.
5. Avoid selling calls or puts until the student understands assignment, margin, obligations, and worst-case outcomes.
6. Use small simulated size and track option price, underlying price, expiration, and bid/ask spread.
7. Review every options paper trade for whether the underlying moved as expected and whether the option still lost value.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Believing long calls are simple because loss is capped while ignoring expiration and spread.
- Buying puts without a downside target and invalidation level.
- Selling options before understanding assignment.
- Using options when shares would better match the thesis.

Student drill

Build a one-page comparison: long call, long put, short call, short put. The student may paper-trade only long calls and long puts until all four are understood.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can explain the difference between the buyer's right and the seller's obligation.

Source-backed study note: OIC explains that calls give holders the right to buy 100 shares and puts give holders the right to sell 100 shares. OCC stresses that options involve risk and are not suitable for all investors. See Sources [9], [10], and [11].

Tutorial 13: Cash-Secured Puts as an Advanced "Get Paid to Wait" Strategy

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	Cash-secured puts were assigned as homework after Anthony showed a stronger directional thesis in AMC and other low-priced names.
Objective	Introduce cash-secured puts only after shares, strike price, premium, assignment, and downside risk are understood.
Core rule	A cash-secured put is not a free-money trade. It is a stock-acquisition strategy with risk.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Choose only a stock the student would be willing to own at the strike price.
2. Set aside enough cash to buy 100 shares per contract if assigned.
3. Select a strike where ownership would make sense, not merely where premium looks attractive.
4. Calculate premium received and effective purchase price: strike minus premium.
5. Calculate worst-case downside if the stock falls sharply.
6. Compare the cash-secured put to simply placing a buy limit order below the market.
7. Do not use cash-secured puts on names the student would panic-own after assignment.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Treating premium as free income while ignoring assignment risk.
- Selling puts on stocks the student does not want to own.
- Failing to reserve enough cash for assignment.
- Choosing high premium because the stock is risky, then being surprised by the risk.

Student drill

Pick one stock the student would be willing to own. Calculate cash required, premium received, effective purchase price, breakeven, and worst-case loss if the stock falls near zero.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can explain why a cash-secured put is closer to a planned stock purchase than to a directional lottery ticket.

Source-backed study note: OIC describes the cash-secured put as writing a put while setting aside enough cash to buy the stock if assigned. See Source [12].

Tutorial 14: Price Path Simulation and Monte Carlo Thinking

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	The session linked Anthony's technical-analysis scenarios to Monte Carlo thinking: draw possible paths, then later learn quantitative simulation.
Objective	Turn chart reading into scenario planning instead of prediction.
Core rule	Do not ask, "What will happen?" Ask, "What are the possible paths and what is my plan for each?"

Step-by-step protocol

1. Start from current price and draw three possible paths: bullish, bearish, and sideways/compression.
2. For each path, mark expected support, resistance, target, and invalidation.
3. Estimate which path is most likely, but do not force a trade if uncertainty is high.
4. Write the required evidence for each path to become active: clean close, volume expansion, VWAP reclaim, failed support, or rejection.
5. Use alerts at the key transition points between paths.
6. After the session, compare actual price path to the three planned paths.
7. Use the review to improve future scenarios, not to prove the student was right or wrong.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Drawing only the bullish path because that is what the trader wants.
- Treating a hand-drawn path as a prediction rather than a planning tool.
- Forgetting the sideways path, even though markets often range.
- Changing the scenario after the trade goes against the student without documenting why.

Student drill

For one chart, draw bullish, bearish, and sideways paths. Assign each path a trigger, stop, target, and rough probability estimate.

Mastery checkpoint

The student can create a plan for multiple outcomes and stay calm when price chooses one of them.

Source-backed study note: Monte Carlo simulation is a statistical method that relies on repeated random samples to understand uncertain outcomes. See Source [15].

Tutorial 15: Student Learning Protocol: Paper First, Then Small Size, Then Review

Field	Student-facing summary
Session anchor	The session ended with homework, review, and the reminder that Anthony should test ideas and avoid betting his own money until the process is stronger.
Objective	Create a repeatable learning loop that protects capital while building skill.
Core rule	Skill development is a sequence: paper, review, small size, review again.

Step-by-step protocol

1. Require 30 documented paper trades before any live-money escalation.
2. Every trade must include: setup, timeframe, entry, stop, target, risk/reward, exit reason, and emotional state.
3. Review losing trades for rule breaks, not just financial loss.
4. Review winning trades for process quality, not just profit.
5. Move from paper to small size only when the student can follow the checklist under pressure.
6. Scale position size only after consistency, not after one good trade.
7. Keep a homework list: order placement, support/resistance labels, indicator template, cash-secured put research, and price-path scenarios.

Common mistakes to prevent

- Going live because paper trading feels boring.
- Increasing size after a lucky win.
- Ignoring emotional state in the journal.
- Treating homework as optional while expecting skill to improve.

Student drill

Complete a 30-trade paper journal. Each entry must include setup, timeframe, entry, stop, target, risk/reward, exit, emotional state, and lesson learned.

Mastery checkpoint

The student has a written process that can be repeated, reviewed, and improved.

Source-backed study note: TradingView Paper Trading is suitable for practicing analysis and chart-based trade execution without using real money. See Source [5].

Appendix A: Student Worksheets

The following templates can be printed or copied into a trading journal. They are designed to force written thinking before any action.

Worksheet 1 - Order Ticket Read-Aloud

Field	Student entry
Symbol	
Side	Buy / Sell / Sell to close / Buy to close
Quantity	
Order type	Market / Limit / Stop / Stop-limit
Limit price	
Stop price	
Time in force	Day / GTC / Other
Thesis	
Invalidation level	
What could go wrong?	

Worksheet 2 - Risk/Reward Calculator

Item	Value
Entry price	
Stop price	
Risk per share/contract	
Position size	
Total dollar risk	
Target 1	
Target 2	
Potential reward	
Reward-to-risk ratio	
Accept / reject trade?	

Worksheet 3 - Support and Resistance Map

Level	Type	Evidence	Action if touched
	Current support / minor support / major support		
	Current resistance / minor resistance / major resistance		
	VWAP / SMA / anchored VWAP		
	Microstructure		
	Breakout trigger		
	Invalidation		

Worksheet 4 - Alert Plan

Alert name	Price/condition	Purpose	Planned response
Entry trigger		Enter / observe	
Invalidation		Exit / reduce risk	
Target 1		Scale out	
Re-entry trigger		Fresh bias	
No-trade warning		Avoid chase	

Worksheet 5 - 30-Trade Paper Journal Template

Print this page several times or recreate it in a spreadsheet. A completed journal requires every field. Blank fields mean the trade does not count toward the 30-trade requirement.

#	Symbol	Setup	TF	Entry	Stop	Target	Exit	R:R	Lesson
1									
2									
3									
4									
5									
6									
7									
8									
9									
10									
11									
12									
13									
14									
15									

Appendix B: Assessment Rubric

Skill	Needs work	Developing	Ready for next layer
Order placement	Misplaces order types or side	Correct in slow practice	Correct under time pressure with read-aloud
Risk management	Enters before stop/target	Has stop and target but inconsistent sizing	Defines risk/reward before every entry
Chart structure	Draws random lines	Identifies support/resistance with some evidence	Classifies current/minor/major levels with reasons
Execution mode	Mixes scalp and momentum emotionally	Can name the intended style	Switches styles only with confirmation
Options understanding	Confuses rights and obligations	Understands long call/put basics	Understands why short options and CSPs require assignment knowledge
Review loop	Does not journal	Journals some trades	Completes every paper-trade record and reviews mistakes

Promotion rule

The student advances only when the process is repeatable. A profitable paper trade does not prove readiness if the order ticket, stop, target, or journal is incomplete.

Source Notes

These external sources were used to add depth and standard definitions to the student material. They should be assigned as supplemental reading where appropriate.

Ref	Source	URL
[1]	Investor.gov - Types of Orders	https://www.investor.gov/introduction-investing/investing-basics/how-stock-markets-work/types-orders
[2]	Investor.gov - Stop, Stop-Limit, and Trailing Stop Orders	https://www.investor.gov/introduction-investing/general-resources/news-alerts/alerts-bulletins/investor-bulletins-15
[3]	TradingView Support - Volume Weighted Average Price (VWAP)	https://www.tradingview.com/support/solutions/43000502018-volume-weighted-average-price-vwap/
[4]	TradingView Support - How to set up alerts	https://www.tradingview.com/support/solutions/43000595315-how-to-set-up-alerts/
[5]	TradingView Support - Paper Trading main functionality	https://www.tradingview.com/support/solutions/43000516466-paper-trading-main-functionality/
[6]	StockCharts ChartSchool - Support and Resistance	https://chartschool.stockcharts.com/table-of-contents/chart-analysis/support-and-resistance
[7]	StockCharts ChartSchool - Finding Support and Resistance in Moving Averages	https://chartschool.stockcharts.com/table-of-contents/trading-strategies-and-models/trading-strategies/moving-average-trading-strategies/finding-support-and-resistance-in-moving-averages
[8]	SEC - Microcap Stock: A Guide for Investors	https://www.sec.gov/about/reports-publications/investorpubsmicrocapstock
[9]	Options Industry Council - Options Basics	https://www.optionseducation.org/optionsoverview/options-basics
[10]	Options Industry Council - Long Put	https://www.optionseducation.org/strategies/all-strategies/long-put
[11]	OCC - Options risk statement and Characteristics and Risks of Standardized Options	https://www.theocc.com/company-information/documents-and-archives/options-disclosure-document
[12]	Options Industry Council - Cash-Secured Put	https://www.optionseducation.org/strategies/all-strategies/cash-secured-put
[13]	Options Industry Council - Open Interest: Why It Matters	https://www.optionseducation.org/news/open-interest-why-it-matters
[14]	Nasdaq Listing Center - Nasdaq 5500 Series Rules	https://listingcenter.nasdaq.com/rulebook/nasdaq/rules/nasdaq-5500-series
[15]	Corporate Finance Institute - Monte Carlo Simulation	https://corporatefinanceinstitute.com/resources/financial-modeling/monte-carlo-simulation/
[16]	FINRA Rule 2270 - Day-Trading Risk Disclosure Statement	https://www.finra.org/rules-guidance/rulebooks/finra-rules/2270

Final reminder

This packet is a teaching guide and paper-trading framework. It should not be treated as a recommendation to buy, sell, or trade any security or derivative.